



2025-2026

University of Central Missouri Mulekickers Handbook of Policies and Procedures

Purpose

The purpose of the Mulekicker dance team is to provide support to ALL Central athletic teams and the University. This support is directed in three major areas:

1. To raise the level of fan support for Central athletics by entertaining the crowd in an appropriate manner, to lead the crowd in positive support for ALL teams and to project and solicit that support from the fans.
2. To serve as public relations ambassadors of athletics and Central, and to uphold and project the goals, ideals, and standards of the institution at all times.
3. To participate in Mulekickers by dancing at halftime and performing sideline cheer movements for the entertainment of the crowd at each game.

Mulekicker Administrator

The Assistant Athletics Director for Student-Athlete Services is the athletics administrator for the Mulekicker program and is located in Multipurpose Building Room 203. All questions and concerns should be addressed first to the Coach and then the coach will address the athletics administrator if needed.

Communication

Professional communication is expected for coaches and athletes. The use of the BAND APP is preferred, but email is also acceptable. Please keep questions that can be answered by posts/calendar events in the BAND APP and to a minimum and ask other teammates simple questions before reaching out to the coaches.

Cost

****New Coaching Staff****

Expenses are to be determined but should be approximately \$500-\$750 per athlete. This section will be updated before 2025-2026 auditions.

Scholarship/Academics

The current spirit scholarship amount is awarded on an individual basis and is determined by number of years on the squad, eligibility, and whether you are a captain or not.

Each year Mulekickers will receive a scholarship amounting to \$500.00 per semester. Dancers receive a \$100.00 raise per semester each year they stay on the team. Scholarships may fluctuate year to year depending on what funding is available.

To receive or maintain the spirit scholarship each Mulekicker must be enrolled in at least 12 semester hours in order to practice and perform. For the fall and spring semesters, squad members must earn 24 semester hours in order to be eligible the following fall - assuming they earn a place on the squad.

*****Any Mulekicker who is put on Academic Probation will result in the loss of their scholarship for the following semester!

Please keep in mind that by University rules a 2.0 GPA will keep you in school. If you have two consecutive semesters below a 2.0 GPA you will be suspended. Failure to stay enrolled in 12 semester hours per semester, achieve 24 semester hours in the fall and spring semesters combined, and dropping below your GPA requirement will render you ineligible and result in written expulsion from the squad.

- At any point in time if the coach feels that your academics/grades are not up to par you will either be suspended or released from the team at the coach's discretion.
- At any point in time the coach will be doing grade checks. At which time you will have to have all UCM Instructors fill out and sign a grade check sheet.
- It is in your best interest to make the coach aware of any grades that may not be up to par. The coach will guide you in the direction of getting a tutor.

Time Commitment

Student athletes must be organized in order to fulfill student obligations and squad responsibilities.

Commitments to the dance team include participation in ALL PRACTICES and HOME GAMES (Football and Men's and Women's Basketball), ALONG WITH assigned fundraising events, charitable functions, workouts, and study hall as scheduled by the Coach and/or athletic administrator.

Mulekickers will be given an athletic event calendar for each semester. Each member must schedule work, dates, sorority/fraternity functions, family vacations and other events around the athletic calendar. *Your first priority is your academics, after that, dance comes above everything else.*

*The calendar is a working document and additions and deletions will be made as necessary throughout the year.

Post Season Travel

Mulekickers are REQUIRED to travel with post-season play (pending academic classes) and are expected to perform at these games and make appearances in support of Central athletics. These dates typically include, but are not limited to, most University holidays. This includes: Thanksgiving, Christmas, and Spring Break. Members should plan accordingly.

If only a limited number of Mulekickers are permitted to travel, the Coach will determine who will participate based on veteran status, grades, attendance, attitude and dance ability.

Practices are scheduled three times a week and additional practices may be required when determined necessary by the Coach.

Camp/Summer Practices

1. Location of summer camp will be at the discretion of the coach.
2. Team members are responsible for paying for the cost of camp:
 - a. Camp Usually Cost--\$300-500 which includes food and hotel during the days of camp. All other food on other days will be at the cost of the dancer. The cost depends on the location of the camp. Whether it be home based or away in another location.
3. There will be practices throughout the summer at the discretion of the coach.
 - a. You should expect to practice in the months of May, June, July, and Camp being in August per Coaches discretion.
 - b. These practices are not to be missed and follow the rules in the practice and time commitment section of this document.
4. The WHOLE TEAM is expected to participate in summer fundraisers.
5. There will be practices throughout the summer at the discretion of the coach.
 - a. You should expect to practice in the months of May, June, July, and August per Coaches discretion.
 - b. These practices are not to be missed and follow the rules in the practice and time commitment section of this document.

****Additionally, Mulekickers must attend camp in the summer. Not attending summer practices and camp will result in dismissal and/or consequences from the team/squad. The coach has sole discretion on the results of squad dismissal, benching, or being moved into an alternate position.*

Practices

1. Practices are Tuesdays, Wednesdays, and Sundays from 5:00-8:00pm
2. Mulekickers will adhere to the Coach's agenda. Failure to cooperate with the agenda will result in suspension from the squad.
3. Mulekickers must arrive appropriately dressed and ready to begin practice/performance at the scheduled time.
4. Work and personal business will not be excused and must be scheduled around any scheduled Mulekicker events.
5. Along with practices during the week, the Mulekickers will be required to run/workout on their own during the summer and during the season to maintain/increase their physical fitness.
6. Mulekickers are expected to come prepared and knowledgeable of the required material for that practice.
7. Semester break practices may be necessary. Should the Coach determine it necessary to practice over semester break, she will schedule the practices and these practices will be mandatory.
8. Being late to practice will result in conditioning for the entire team. You are expected to show up at least 10 minutes before the scheduled start time and be completely ready to go when practice starts.

9. You are required to wear appropriate attire to practice. Clothing in the colors of red, gray, black, and white are the only clothing allowed.
10. All cell phones should be put on DND, vibrate, or turned off during practices.

Games

1. Mulekickers are to arrive dressed in the designated uniform (including shoes), ready to begin stretching and preparing for performance. Arrival time will be at the Coach's discretion.
2. Complete knowledge of material is required for participation at games.
 - a. It is the Coach's discretion to whether all athletes will participate in games.
3. Abusive or obscene language, or criticism of officials, Coach's, athletes, fans, etc., are prohibited and will result in immediate benching or dismissal from the team.
4. Upon advancing to post season play, additional restrictions may be implemented by the MIAA Conference and the NCAA. The Coach and athletics administrator will inform the Mulekickers of any such restrictions.
5. The athletics administrator will determine attendance at away games. If it is determined that the squad will attend an away game, transportation by the University (bus or van) will be provided. If a Mulekicker rides the bus or van to an away game, they must ride the bus or van back home. Mulekickers will be permitted to ride home with their parent(s) or legal guardian(s) provided the parent(s) or legal guardian(s) speaks directly to the Coach or athletics administrator prior to departing from the away sight. The athlete must have a signed consent/waiver that the athlete is responsible for obtaining from the athletic office prior to the game day.
6. *See section on Absences, Late Arrivals and Early Departures*
7. *See section on Expected Behaviors and Standards*

Competition

Competitive events may or may not be a required responsibility of all the squad members. Should the Mulekickers elect to participate in competitive events, the *Coach reserves the right to select team members for this competition*. Competition will require funding and/or fundraising by the student-athlete. **All athletes including those not on the competitive team will be required to help fundraise for the team.** You are still part of the team just not on the competitive squad. All alternates are required to attend and participate in all nationals practices.

Absences, Late Arrivals, Early Departures

1. Excused absences/tardies or early departure from practice, a game or performance are permitted and include class, sickness, or a death in the family. The Mulekicker must submit to the Coach a doctor's excuse for absences due to sickness. If sickness becomes excessive then the coach reserves the right to bench athletes/dancers after missed practices, games, or events.
2. Any tardy, arriving in the wrong uniform, or leaving uniform pieces at home will result in disciplinary action for the entire squad and/or benching of the individual. This will be determined by the Coach at the next acceptable time. Usually there will be conditioning for the whole team which will either be at practice or at the game, it's the Coach's discretion.

3. Missing a practice will result in an automatic benching for the next game/performance following the practice you missed. The Coach can make the decision based on the attitude, performance, or circumstance for which practice/game was missed.
4. Missing a game/performance will result in an automatic benching for the next game/performance following the practice you missed. The Coach can make the decision based on the attitude, performance, or circumstance for which practice/game was missed.
5. Excessive absences/tardiness/arriving in the wrong uniform will result in benching/suspension or expulsion from the squad determined at the Coach's discretion. See section on **Benching, Suspension, and Expulsion.**
 - i. All circumstances are up to the Coach's discretion. If at any time the team Coach feels that the above consequences are either too harsh or not harsh enough, the Coach has sole discretion of the athlete's consequences.

Expected Behaviors and Standards

1. Each Mulekicker is expected to follow the University's Regulations/Policies which are published annually in the Student Calendar/Handbook. Violations of the Regulations/Policies may result in, but are not limited to, disciplinary reprimand, probation, or expulsion from the squad/University.
2. Mulekickers must remain in good academic standing by maintaining a 2.0 cumulative grade point average and carry at least 12 credit hours per semester. Should a Mulekicker drop below 12 credit hours or should their cumulative GPA drop below 2.0, they will be suspended from the squad.
 - a. At any point in time if the coach feels that your academics/grades are not up to par you will either be suspended or released from the team at the coach's discretion.
 - b. At any point in time the coach will be doing grade checks. At which time you will have to have all UCM Instructors fill out and sign a grade check sheet.
 - c. **It is in your best interest to make the coach aware of any grades that may not be up to par. The coach will guide you in the direction of getting a tutor.**
3. University of Central Missouri strongly opposes the use of illegal drugs, excessive alcohol and the use of tobacco products, including smokeless tobacco. The use of these products is specifically prohibited while on the University grounds, while traveling to and from University events, while in attendance at University events, and on social media.
 - a. Use of illegal drugs, excessive drinking, and/or underage drinking could lead to suspension or dismissal from the team.
4. Wearing of uniforms and/or Mulekicker jackets to any party, bar, or while participating in any illegal activities as well as smoking or consuming alcohol in this apparel is prohibited. It will result in removal from the team.
5. If any athletics administrator or coach determines a Mulekicker smells of alcohol or appears to be physically or mentally unprepared to practice or perform at a game or function, immediate suspension or removal from the team will result.
6. Mulekickers represent the squad, the Coach, the athletic department, and the University and are required to act accordingly both in person and on social media.

7. Mulekickers will be expected to remain in good physical condition. In addition to scheduled practices, Mulekickers are expected to engage in cardiovascular/aerobic conditioning and weight training outside of practices.
8. See section on **Benching, Suspension and Expulsion.**
9. See section on **Absences, Late Arrivals and Early departures.**

Game Ready Attire

1. Hair and makeup must be worn as described before the game/performance by the Coach.
2. The only jewelry permitted are team earrings.
3. The correct shoes must be worn to games/performances; they are part of the uniform.
4. **Facial piercings must be removed during games and performances.**

Uniforms

1. Uniforms must be kept neat and clean. Mulekickers must turn in uniforms before the day of tryouts, clean and in good condition. Any damaged items must be repaired to the satisfaction of the Coach/athletics administrator or a cost will be imposed to replace the uniform.
2. All uniforms must be washed AS DIRECTED when handed out. Do not dry clean uniforms.
3. Failure to return uniforms or returning damaged uniforms will result in a hold on your account with Central which will prevent you from getting your grades and/or diploma, enrolling into courses for the next semester, etc.
4. Mulekickers who are on the team will have uniforms provided by the school .
5. Alternates may not be provided with a full uniform.

Benching, Suspension and Expulsion

1. Failure to comply with the rules set forth in this handbook and the University's policies will result in benching, suspension or expulsion.
2. Once a Mulekicker is benched or suspended, the benching or suspension continues until the Coach and athletics administrator have discussed the situation and made a decision to continue the benching or suspension, cancel the benching or suspension, or expel the Mulekicker from the squad.
 - a. The Mulekicker may or may not be involved in the discussions with the Coach and athletics administrator when considering final actions to be taken.
 - b. The Mulekicker has the right to appeal the decision made by the Coach and athletics administrator to the athletic director. Appeals must be made by approaching the Coach first. The Coach will take the appeal to administration.
 - c. The benched Mulekicker will participate in practice and is expected to attend games, in full uniform, sitting on the sidelines in close proximity to the coach.
 - d. The suspended Mulekicker will turn in all Mulekicker items and will not participate in practices or games until a decision on their situation has been reached.
 - e. **Expulsion from the squad requires all Mulekicker items to be turned in and prohibits the student from future participation in the Mulekicker program at Central.**
 - f. Benching, suspension and/or expulsion from the Mulekickers may result from, but is not limited to, the following:

- Unexcused/excessive tardiness; unexcused absences from practices or games; habitual arrival in incorrect uniform.
- Lack of enthusiasm, poor attitude, or the inability to learn and perform routines/sidelines at the minimum standards.
- Inability to follow the Expected Behaviors and Standards.
- Behavior inappropriate for a representative of Central including anything posted on social media (i.e. stories, reels, TikTok videos, re-posting of others, etc.)
- Missing the bus for an away game.
- Violating policies set by Central and Central's Student Calendar/Handbook, the Mulekicker Coach and the athletics administrator.
- Alcohol/tobacco/drug use which impairs the Mulekickers ability to practice or perform safely.
- Use of tobacco or consumption of alcohol while wearing any Mulekicker uniform, t-shirts, and/or jacket.

Fundraising

In order to afford uniforms, costumes, choreographer fees, and competition expenses ALL Mulekickers must help with fundraising events. Over the summer Mulekickers and UCM Cheerleaders work Royals games. All Mulekickers are required to work the amount of games determined by the team contract with Aramark Concessions. If an athlete has a scheduling conflict with one of their scheduled games. They must reach out to the Coach and include the dancer they intend to swap with in said message. All Mulekickers will help work the silent auction during the UCM Athletic Auction as a team fundraiser. Each member is responsible for finding an item to be donated during the auction. Auction items can include donations from businesses, handmade baskets, or other items approved by the coach. Mulekickers will participate in any other additional fundraisers done throughout the season to assist with yearly expenses.

****Review the next page regarding Physicals, Insurance, and Injuries****

Physicals, Insurance, and Injuries

Each Mulekicker is expected to have their own primary health insurance to cover them for the entire school year. If you do not have primary health insurance, the University has insurance you may purchase. See the athletics administrator for information.

Each Mulekicker must complete a physical. All dancers will meet with the UCM Athletic trainers to have their paperwork completed before getting their physical to clear them to participate. You will need to provide a front and back copy of your insurance card.

Failure to submit this information accurately and completely will prohibit you from participating in practices, camps, and games until the information is submitted. Should your insurance change during the school year, you must complete and submit another insurance form with front and back copies of your new insurance card.

****Important Injury Information****

Should you become injured during practice or a game, you must be seen by one of the athletic trainers. If you are able to go to the training room nearest you, do so. If you are not able to physically take yourself to the training room, you must have another Mulekicker or your Coach go to the training room to have an athletic trainer come to you. The athletic trainer will determine if you need to be seen by a local doctor. If an athletic trainer determines that you should be seen by a local doctor, the trainer will give you an injury report form to take to the doctor's office with you. You are to return the injury report form to the athletic trainer after your doctor visit.

Should you become injured and the athletic trainer sends you for local medical attention, your primary insurance will pay their allowable amount. University of Central Missouri is the secondary insurance and will pay the remaining balance provided you have valid insurance with complete information and proper physical information. In order for Central to pay your remaining medical costs, you will need to bring all bills and Explanations of Benefits to the athletics administrator. Should you fail to provide proper and accurate insurance information, University of Central Missouri will not be responsible for your medical bills, however great they may be.

Athletes/Mulekickers of the University of Central Missouri

“Respect and Responsibility” is the theme that governs the conduct and behavior of the University of Central Missouri Athletes and Mulekickers. In our 2025-2026 Mulekicker Handbook of Policies and Procedures the procedures, rules, and regulations are mentioned.

You will also find information regarding our dance goals, procedures, standards, expectations, rules, and objectives as well as information on camp, practices, and UCM Mulekicker information.

I understand it is my responsibility to familiarize myself with the contents of this handbook. I agree to read the handbook and abide by the standards, policies, and procedures defined or referenced in this document. The information in this handbook is subject to change. I understand that changes in Mulekicker policies at UCM may supersede, modify, or eliminate the information summarized in this handbook. As the University provides updated policy or procedure information, I accept responsibility for reading and abiding by the changes.

I understand that not abiding by the principles stated in the handbook may result in demotion to an alternate position or dismissal from the Mulekickers. All decisions are final and at the Coach’s discretion.

I acknowledge that I have reviewed the procedures and guidelines as presented in the 2025-2026 University of Central Missouri Handbook.

Mulekicker Name: First & Last (Please Print)

Mulekicker Signature

Date

I understand that my Scholarship for the 25-26 School Year will be awarded at the start of each semester. My scholarship will be forfeited if I am dismissed, expelled, demoted to an alternate position, produce substandard grades, or if I quit the UCM Mulekickers.